

Pollinator Network Draft and Build

Draft a pollinator habitat that works all season, not just on the prettiest day.

Win condition: Highest pollinator support across spring, summer, and fall using native and clumping logic.

THE SCIENCE YOU ARE USING

Networks, not single plants. Pollinators need food across the whole season, not just one bloom. A good habitat is a network: plants that flower in spring, summer, and fall, matched to the pollinators that visit them. Gaps in the calendar starve the system.

Native and clumping logic. Native plants tend to support local pollinators best, and planting in clumps helps insects find and work them efficiently. You draft plant and pollinator cards, then place them on a grid under these constraints.

HOW TO BUILD AND RUN IT

- 01 Draft your cards.** Pick plant and pollinator cards. Note bloom season and which pollinators each plant supports (most flowers feed several kinds).
- 02 Cover every season.** Lay out plants so something blooms in spring, summer, and fall. Use season tokens to check coverage.
- 03 Apply native and clumping rules.** Favor natives and group same plants in clumps so pollinators forage efficiently.
- 04 Connect the network.** Make sure each pollinator has food across its active months, not just one.
- 05 Defend the design.** Explain how your grid supports the most pollinators across the whole season.

Safety: No live insects required. Students only handle cards and grid materials. Allergy: None.

MATERIALS

Plant cards	one deck per team (4 teams, plus 1 spare)
Pollinator cards	one deck per team (4, plus 1 spare, in the same deck set)
Grid boards	one per team (4, plus 1 spare)
Season tokens	one spring/summer/fall set per team (4)
Markers	shared
Stickers	shared

YOUR PLAN AND DESIGN

A clear, well-defended layout is worth as much as a fast finish.

Prediction (what will work best, and why): _____

Seasons we covered (spring / summer / fall) and any gap: _____

Pollinators our grid feeds, and the plant that feeds each: _____

Our native and clumping choices, and why: _____

DEFEND YOUR DESIGN

What evidence made you change your design? _____

If you ran it again, what is the ONE thing you would change? _____

HOW YOU SCORE (100 POINTS)

SCORING CRITERION	POINTS
Seasonal coverage	30
Pollinator fit	25
Native and clumping logic	20
Layout clarity	15
Defense	10
Total	100